

the home computer manufacturing business looking at the success of the Commodore and Spectrum series. The IBM Personal Computer (PC) was truly the dawn of a revolution, and the first of the many computer models it sold. In fact, it was the earliest ancestor of the PC as we know it. Think PC and think IBM... not Microsoft or Intel, at least in the context of history!



The ancestor of the PC we know and love

The team dedicated to the development of this new brand of machines was headed by Don Estridge, now regarded the Father of the PC. They christened the endeavour Project Chess; the project was completed in 1981.

IBM's first PC prototypes were bulky and not considered ideal for the personal computer market. Over generations of models, the PC evolved into one compact unit with customised software. Now here's where the tale took a turn, and here's why we mostly use PCs today rather than, say, Macs: IBM built the hardware in collaboration with Original Equipment Manufacturers (OEMs)—an “open architecture” model. This meant the OEMs could produce peripherals and other hardware that was compatible with the PC, and ensured that as more IBM PC-compatible hardware was available, prices would drop.



The Father of the modern-day PC, Don Estridge

When first released on August 21, 1981, the PC operated on an IBM OS. However, IBM later decided to use Microsoft's DOS, known at the time as PC-DOS, since it was more widely used—despite the original OS being many years